

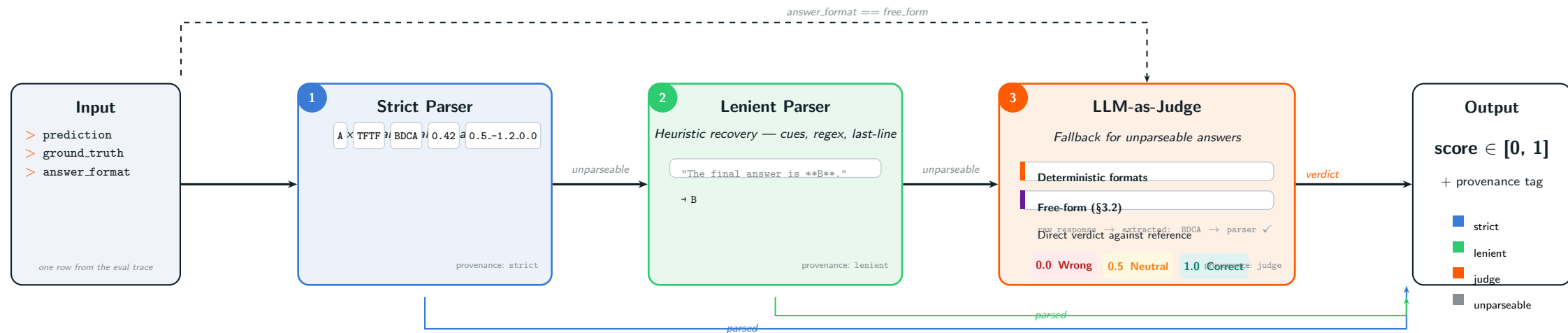


Figure X: Three-step scoring cascade. Deterministic answers are first parsed strictly, then leniently; only unparseable predictions escalate to the LLM-as-judge, which either extracts the canonical answer for re-parsing or, for free-form answers, applies the §3.2 verdict directly.